

v3 curriculum spec — resequencing all five sections for variety

For Claude Code. This is a **pure reordering job**, not a content or mechanics change: no round type is added, removed, or altered; no round text, word list, blank, or card is rewritten; no component under `components/lesson-v2/` changes. The only edits are: (1) the order of entries in each `nodes` array in `data/v2/*_section.json`, (2) one node in each file split into two node objects (same rounds, divided between them — detailed below), and (3) the matching `LABELS.<card>` array in `app/v2/page.js`, reordered and given one new label for the split-off node.

Everything below was derived by reading the actual current content of all five `data/v2/*_section.json` files and `app/v2/page.js` directly — nothing here is inferred from format names alone.

Why

Today, all five sections open with a long run of the same interaction — tap the word chip that belongs to the card — repeated across five or six nodes before any other format appears, and the newer, more interesting formats (swipe, fill-in-the-blank, multiple choice) are clustered together at the very end. That's the source of the "repetitive and boring" feedback. It's not a Fool-specific issue: Lovers, Magician, Empress, and Emperor all have the identical shape. Three of them (Lovers, Magician, Emperor) also open the *entire section* on the drag-to-region "Find the elements" node — the exact placement Simon already moved away from in the Fool specifically because it read as too abstract for a learner's first-ever node in that section (see the comment above `LABELS.foo1` in `app/v2/page.js`). That fix was never carried over to the other three.

The shape every section moves to

Every section gets the same interleaving template applied to its own existing content: open on the fill-in-the-blank "description" node (which is being split into an easy intro and a hard capstone, see below), then swipe, then elements (where that section has it), then the first keyword node — and from there, alternate formats and keep each format's own difficulty climbing, never repeating a format two nodes in a row except at two unavoidable points explained below, closing on multiple choice into the fill-in-the-blank capstone.

The one structural move — splitting the description node. In every section, the "Fill in the blank: description" node's last round is far bigger than the rest of that node — the entire card description as a single paragraph with many more blanks than any other round in the section

(12 blanks for Fool/Lovers/Magician/Emperor, 9 for Empress, against 3 blanks in every round before it). Opening a section with that mega-round still attached would mean either spiking straight to the section's hardest content before anything else is taught, or leaving it stranded mid-sequence once everything else moves. So in every section, that node splits into two node objects using the same rounds, nothing rewritten:

- **Intro** — every round in the node except the last one. Keep this node's original id (e.g. **node-8**). This opens the section.
- **Capstone** — just the final, largest round, alone in its own node. Give this node a new id: original id + **-capstone** (e.g. **node-8-capstone**). This closes the section. Give it a new label too — reusing "Fill in the blank: description" for both would read as a duplicate rather than a deliberate bookend; "**The full picture**" is one option, pick whatever reads best in context.

This is the only place a node is added: each section gains exactly one node (13 → 14 for the four sections with a zone node, 12 → 13 for Empress).

Two unavoidable adjacent repeats. Keyword-tap has six nodes in every section — more than any other format — and once the opening four slots and the closing two slots are fixed by the shape above, there aren't enough non-keyword nodes left in the middle to separate all six without at least two pairs touching. Every section's plan below puts those two repeats at the same relative points: right where the keyword format itself changes shape (2-word rounds into 6-word rounds), and at the very end of the keyword progression (its two hardest tiers, back to back, right before the closing stretch). That's deliberate placement, not an oversight — flagging it here so it isn't "fixed" by accident later.

Fool, Lovers, Magician, Emperor — one shared recipe

These four sections currently share the exact same node-id-to-role mapping (only the *order* they're currently listed in differs by section — Fool's was already hand-adjusted once, the other three weren't). So the same target order applies to all four, by id:

node-8 (intro) → **node-11** → **node-1** → **node-2** → **node-12** → **node-3** → **node-9** → **node-4** → **node-5** → **node-13** → **node-6** → **node-7** → **node-10** → **node-8-capstone**

New position	id	Format	Role
1	node-8 (intro)	Cloze	Description, easy rounds only
2	node-11	Swipe	Tier 1 (obvious)
3	node-1	Zone + tile match	Find the elements

New position	id	Format	Role
4	node-2	Keyword tap	First words (tutorial round lives here)
5	node-12	Swipe	Tier 2
6	node-3	Keyword tap	More new words
7	node-9	Cloze	Readings (short phrases, different vocab from the description)
8	node-4	Keyword tap	Opposites / Closer distractors (2-word, real-word tier)
9	node-5	Keyword tap	Six at once / Obvious wrong answers (6-word, first appearance — adjacent to #8, see note above)
10	node-13	Swipe	Tier 3 (other-card distractors)
11	node-6	Keyword tap	Trickier confusables / Real-word confusables (6-word)
12	node-7	Keyword tap	Spontaneity mastery / Final mastery (6-word, hardest — adjacent to #11)
13	node-10	Multiple choice	Pick the true reading
14	node-8-capstone	Cloze	The full picture — full paragraph, hardest round in the section

New LABELS arrays

For **fool** (each section keeps its own existing wording for shared roles):

JavaScript

```
fool: [  
  "Fill in the blank: description",  
  "Does it match?",  
  "Find the elements",  
  "First words",  
  "Trickier matches",  
  "More new words",  
  "Fill in the blank: readings",  
  "Closer distractors",  
  "Six at once",  
  "Hardest matches",  
  "Trickier confusables",  
  "Spontaneity mastery",  
  "Pick the true reading",  
  "The full picture",  
],
```

For **lovers**, **magician**, and **emperor** (identical to each other today, so identical here too):

JavaScript

```
[  
  "Fill in the blank: description",  
  "Does it match?",  
  "Find the elements",  
  "First words",  
  "Trickier matches",  
  "More new words",  
  "Fill in the blank: readings",  
  "Opposites",  
  "Obvious wrong answers",  
  "Hardest matches",  
  "Real-word confusables",  
  "Final mastery",  
  "Pick the true reading",  
  "The full picture",  
],
```

Empress — its own recipe (no zone node)

Empress has no "Find the elements" node at all — its card-element crops were dropped a while back (see the comment above [LABELS.empress](#)) — so the "then elements" step in the shared shape above simply doesn't exist here. Everything else follows the same logic, just with that one step removed and the rest closing up. Empress's cloze-description node is [node-7](#), with 4 rounds instead of 5 (3 easy + the mega round, 9 blanks instead of 12).

[node-7 \(intro\)](#) → [node-10](#) → [node-1](#) → [node-11](#) → [node-2](#) → [node-8](#) → [node-3](#) → [node-4](#) → [node-12](#) → [node-5](#) → [node-6](#) → [node-9](#) → [node-7-capstone](#)

New position	id	Format	Role
1	node-7 (intro)	Cloze	Description, easy rounds only
2	node-10	Swipe	Tier 1
3	node-1	Keyword tap	First words (tutorial round lives here)
4	node-11	Swipe	Tier 2
5	node-2	Keyword tap	More new words
6	node-8	Cloze	Readings
7	node-3	Keyword tap	Opposites (2-word — adjacent to #8 below)
8	node-4	Keyword tap	Obvious wrong answers (6-word, first appearance)
9	node-12	Swipe	Tier 3
10	node-5	Keyword tap	Real-word confusables (6-word — adjacent to #11 below)
11	node-6	Keyword tap	Final mastery (6-word, hardest)

New position	id	Format	Role
12	node-9	Multiple choice	Pick the true reading
13	node-7-capstone	Cloze	The full picture

New LABELS.empress

```
JavaScript
empress: [
  "Fill in the blank: description",
  "Does it match?",
  "First words",
  "Trickier matches",
  "More new words",
  "Fill in the blank: readings",
  "Opposites",
  "Obvious wrong answers",
  "Hardest matches",
  "Real-word confusables",
  "Final mastery",
  "Pick the true reading",
  "The full picture",
],
```

Mechanical steps, per file

For each of `fool_section.json`, `lovers_section.json`, `magician_section.json`, `empress_section.json`, `emperor_section.json`:

1. Find the cloze-description node (node-8 in four of the five, node-7 in Empress — identifiable as the cloze node whose last round has far more blanks than the rounds before it).
2. Split it: create two node objects. The first keeps the original id and every round except the last. The second gets `<original-id>-capstone` as its id and contains only that last, largest round.
3. Reorder the section's `nodes` array into the sequence given above for that card.
4. In `app/v2/page.js`, replace that card's array in LABELS with the one given above — same length as the new `nodes` array, same order (label `i` must describe node `i`).

Nothing else in either file changes. Round `id` fields, word lists, blanks, swipe cards, zone rects, tile-match pairs, and choice options are all untouched — only which node they live in, and where that node sits in the array.

Two optional companion fixes, worth doing while in there

Neither is required for the resequencing to work, but both were visible while reading the content and are cheap:

Only Fool's cloze-description node has `"tutorial": true` on its first round. Lovers, Magician, Empress, and Emperor's don't. Under this plan, that node becomes literally the first thing a learner sees in every section, so it's worth adding `"tutorial": true` to the first round of each of those four cards' intro node, matching what Fool already does.

Only Fool's zone node has `"tutorial": true`. Lovers, Magician, and Emperor's zone nodes don't (Empress has no zone node at all). It's no longer literally the first node in any section under this plan, but it's still a new mechanic each time it appears — worth the same treatment.

Verification

`npm test` runs `scripts/check_rounds.mjs`, which rebuilds every round instance and would catch a malformed split (wrong round moved, id collision, an empty node). Restart the dev server after editing anything in `data/` — Next only reads it at startup (`docs/state-of-play.md` flags this as a repeat time-cost). Worth a manual playthrough of at least the Fool end to end afterward: confirm the split capstone node still hands off correctly into the next section (`sectionSlug/nextSection` logic in `components/lesson-v2/node-session.jsx` is keyed on node position within the array, not on specific ids, so the split shouldn't disturb it, but it's exactly the kind of "silent hole" `state-of-play.md` warns nothing will flag on its own).